

Rep. Tom Emmer on Mornings With Maria Bartiromo

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MARIA BARTIROMO:

Joining me now is the House Majority Whip, Minnesota Congressman Tom Emmer. Congressman, great to see you. Thank you so much for being here. This is obviously a priority as your Democrat colleagues have already threatened that once funding runs out at the end of September, they will shut the government down again. Is that your expectation?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, they've made that very clear, whether it's Chuck Schumer, Hakeem Jeffries. Their goal is to create chaos going into the midterms. Most Republicans, Maria, before we left Washington, we passed a similar continuing resolution that would keep the government funded until December 4th. Now, as you've just mentioned, the Senate passed one yesterday, at least the initial stage, which would be through December 11th. Make no mistake about it. If the government shuts down, it is because Democrats want the government to shut down and Republicans and Donald Trump are going to make sure that doesn't happen.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

So do you feel you've got all Republicans behind the CR? I mean, this seems pretty straightforward to me.

REP. TOM EMMER:

The House one did. It was complete. It was a clean CR, as they call it, which means no changes. Nobody got to add something. Nobody got to withdraw something. The Senate has added some anomalies, one of which you've mentioned, I understand, but haven't had a chance to study it, would take away the authority of certain agencies to make decisions. We'll have to see how that plays in the House again. The House has passed one completely clean through December 4th. The Senate is working on one through December 11th. We'll have to see what the final product is when it gets to the House.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

So when when will you get that final text back to the House? And what's the timing in terms of actually getting this over the finish line? Will you be having to stay here next weekend, even though your break is supposed to begin at the end of the week?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Actually, you're talking about Senate House members left over a week ago, senators working through next week. The goal is, I understand the leader is going to try and have that passed off the Senate floor before they leave. We would then get it. It'd be transmitted to the House. And I would imagine we come back on August 31st. I would imagine it'll be one of the first things that the House takes up.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Yeah, that's what I was looking for, what the plan is, because I know the House has been on this break for a week now. Republicans passed a flurry of legislation before you all left, including the framework for Reconciliation 3.0, the Stop Insider Trading Act and the NDAA. Congressman, when when you left, you had this urgency to get all of that done. And now they're all hanging in the balance in the Senate. Clarity Act, Reconciliation 3.0, Save America Act. Do you have any confidence that any of that gets done in the Senate?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Confidence is generated through performance. So I'll have to see what they do in the Senate. Many good things have gone there in the past couple of years and not moved. I will tell you, the House did amazing work, as you point out, before we left, passing an NDAA, passing the budget resolution, passing the Stock Act, Maria, which restricts members of the House, the Congress, being able to trade stocks with trying to curb insider trading. These are huge things that were accomplished in the House. Securing our elections is a number one priority of our president and Republicans. We sent that with a budget resolution over to the Senate. I would hope that they would recognize this is imperative for this country, for the open, fair and transparent election process to continue. Americans need to have confidence. And by the way, Maria, it's an 80 percent issue. Republicans, Democrats and others all don't see a problem with someone having to prove their identity in order to cast a ballot in one of our elections.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Yeah, it certainly is not an 80 percent issue in the Senate that we know. John Thune continues to say he doesn't have the votes, which really is a head scratcher given everything you've just said. So where are we on the midterms, knowing that we may very well not have that legislation in place? We're less than, what, 94 days away from the midterms. Americans' frustration with the Republican Party is growing. A new CNN poll shows Democrats now lead Republicans by eight points on a generic ballot. Another poll show Republicans losing their House majority congressman, even as we talk about these incredibly far left candidates in the Democrat Party. So what's what's your take in terms of going into the midterms and what Republicans need to do to ensure that you're communicating your wins?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, well, I think it's perception, Maria, the perception of the reality in our economy that you need to meet. Right now, there are great things happening in our economy. Nobody wants to talk about 78 cents eggs. Nobody wants to talk about milk. It's under two dollars. No, no. They want to focus on gas prices, which Americans are smarter than the elites in Washington give them credit for. They understand this is related to something that has to get done in Iran. And when you look at the field, I mean, in order for the Senate, in order for the House to flip Maria, the Democrats in the House are going to have to win fifty seven of seventy seven seats that go five points plus or minus five. That is an incredibly steep order. We've got the right candidates. I believe we've still got the right message. I believe Americans are going to speak again the way they did in the twenty twenty four election polls. People just aren't being honest with polls. They show up at the voting booth. That poll is the only one that matters. And I think Republicans are going to do well in November.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Yeah, really interesting. Congressman, we're going to be watching. Thanks so much for being here this morning.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

All right. Tom Emmer joining us. Stay with us.

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